www.narendramodi.in, and drew in 20,000 advance questions. Modi answered eighteen of them in the 114-minute broadcast, which was ultimately seen by over 7,88,000 viewers.[3] Presaging all the touchpoint messages of strong nationalism, developmentalism, techno-governance and a new modernity rooted in tradition that would eventually define Modi's nationwide messaging, the chat also encapsulated the core communications style that would ultimately define Brand Modi. Even the choice of topic, 'Strong and Glorious India long cherished by Vivekananda', served to subliminally connect the Gujarat chief minister to the robust Hindu-ness and cultural confidence symbolised by Swami Vivekananda, who captured the Indian imagination in 1893 with his unapologetic defence of Hinduism at the Parliament of the World's Religions. Further, with Modi becoming the first politician in India to appear on Hangouts, the chat underscored his image as a leader who embraced digital change and technology, as did his messaging on Google.

At a time when most mainstream media houses would not interview Modi without asking questions about the post-Godhra violence in 2002, the choice of moderator was crucial. Devgn had just delivered a hit with the Hindi film *Singham* a year earlier, and starred in the successful *Bol Bachchan* and *Son of Sardar* in 2012. Choosing an actor at the height of his career to anchor the session added to the novelty and spectacle of the event.

It was an early version of the celebrity model that drove the Modi interview with the Bollywood actor Akshay Kumar, which helped change the political narrative in India ahead of the 2019 general elections. As with the 'non-political' interview with Kumar, the 2012 Hangouts session with Devgn focused far more on the personal side of the man, with topics ranging from the intricacies of the Modi kurta to the rise of the Asian century.

The story goes that Google+ had first approached Rahul Gandhi for a session. As a young first-time MP who was still new to politics, he would have been the perfect fit for a young tech platform looking to engage youth through celebrities. Gandhi is said to have refused the offer, and the company then approached Modi, says journalist Brajesh Kumar Singh, who covered the event in